



Fig. 4: Option screen for USSD

istered mobile number. Using this password, you can create your UPI PIN (MPIN). After necessary setups, you can transfer money using this method to any bank account.

6. In UPI app (for example, SBI Pay) it is possible to pay through UPI or bank account method. If you choose UPI, you need to enter your UPI virtual address and details. For bank account transfer, you need to enter account number, IFSC code, payee name, etc.

7. While transferring using UPI, once you enter the virtual address, all other details will get automatically filled in various fields. You will be guided to security MPIN entry, and the transaction will be complete.

Note that, to transfer money through UPI, your bank must support UPI. Most major banks support it, including State Bank of India, Canara Bank, ICICI, UCO Bank, Federal Bank and Punjab National Bank.

BHIM app

Bharat Interface for Money or BHIM (Fig. 3), is a common application for all banks and financial institutions. The app does not require an Internet connection, so it can also work on feature phones. An Aadhaar based payment system will be added soon. After that, for transactions, BHIM will not even need a mobile phone or the Internet; thumb impression would be enough.

BHIM has features like linking bank accounts, sending and receiving money, profile saving, adding



Fig. 5: Steps for fund transfer through USSD code

beneficiaries, changing languages and balance enquiry. Banks supporting UPI are already supporting BHIM app, and there will be more banks supporting it soon.

Steps for using BHIM are the same as UPI. You can use the existing UPI account for BHIM app.

USSD based mobile banking

Until now you saw applications and methods, except in case of BHIM, that needed at least a smartphone and Internet connectivity. But there are times when you do not have access to the Internet or even a smartphone, and that is when USSD based mobile banking can come to your rescue.

USSD is short for Unstructured Supplementary Service Data. Its platform is built by National Unified USSD Platform. Communication between telecom operators and banks is done through global system for mobile (GSM), since it works on phones with basic calling functions. This method aims to reach rural areas and non-English speaking people, and it supports up to 11 Indian languages. You can access your bank account and transactions using your registered mobile number. You also need a Mobile Money Identifier (MMID) and an MPIN, which will be sent to you by your bank.

Steps for using this method are:

1. Dial *99# from our mobile number. You will get a greeting message asking for the first three letters

of your bank's name or its four-letter IFSC code. For example, for HDFC Bank, type HFD (Fig. 4). If you are dialling for the first time, then you will get a welcome message asking you to register.

2. The second screen gives you options where you can type and send the option number and get the information of the bank. For example, if you want to know

your account balance, type 1 and click on Send. You will receive the account balance.

Similarly, to transfer funds using MMID, type 3 in numeric and send. You will then have to enter the ten-digit beneficiary mobile number followed by the recipient's MMID.

3. Enter the transaction amount, followed by space and transaction remarks. Then you will be asked to enter the four-digit MPIN and last four digits of your account number separated by space.

4. Once the transaction is authenticated, funds will be transferred to the beneficiary account.

As of now, there are limitations in options and some error message pops up from time to time. Also, transaction limit is ₹ 5000 per transaction.

Gift cards

A gift card is a pre-stored value money card issued by a merchant or bank. It can be used as an alternate to cash for purchasing in a store or from a retailer. It is similar to a debit/credit card, which has a specific number or code; sometimes, information is available on the magnetic strip at the back.

You can purchase a gift card directly from the merchant or bank, or can also get it online. The person you gift the card to can use it to buy something of his or her choice. The balance can be carried over to the next purchase(s). **EFY**